

3 ARTICLES (A, AN, THE)

Articles are special words that we use before nouns to talk about something specific or general.

For example:

👉 I saw a dog in **the** park.

👉 He ate **an** apple for lunch.

👉 **The** dog I saw in **the** park was very friendly.

When to use "A"

"A" is used before words that begin with a consonant sound and talk about one thing that is not specific.



A chair



A dog

For example:

👉 I have **a** pencil.

👉 She saw **a** bird in the tree.

👉 He is eating **a** mango.

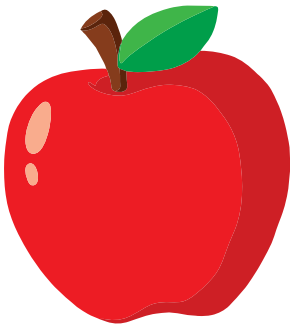
👉 There is **a** cat under the chair.

👉 **A** dog is barking outside.

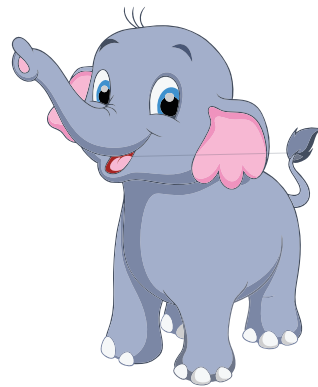
- 👉 I want to buy **a** red balloon.
- 👉 She found **a** flower in the garden.
- 👉 Can you draw **a** star?
- 👉 There is **a** frog in the pond.
- 👉 He has **a** book in his bag.

When to use "An"

"An" is used before words that begin with a vowel sound (a, e, i, o, u) and talk about one thing that is not specific.



An apple



An elephant

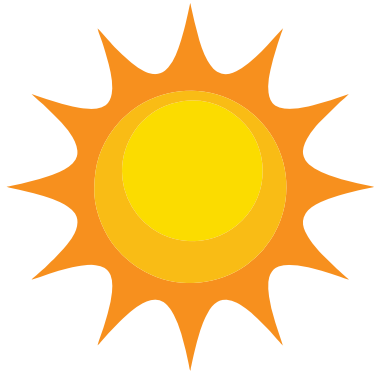
For example:

- 👉 She ate **an** orange for breakfast.
- 👉 She wore **an** elegant dress to the party.
- 👉 He needs **an** eraser to fix his mistake.
- 👉 He ate **an** apple for lunch.
- 👉 She found **an** interesting book at the library.
- 👉 They saw **an** airplane flying high in the sky.

- 👉 He observed **an** ant carrying food.
- 👉 She had **an** ice cream cone on a hot day.
- 👉 They spotted **an** elephant at the zoo.
- 👉 He used **an** ink pen to write his homework.

When to use "The"

"The" is used when we are talking about something specific, something we already know about, or something that is the only one of its kind.



The Sun



The Eiffel Tower

For example:

- 👉 **The** Sun rises in the east.
- 👉 **The** cat is sleeping under the tree.
- 👉 **The** book on the table is mine.
- 👉 **The** sky is blue.
- 👉 **The** teacher is writing on the board.
- 👉 **The** apple is red and sweet.
- 👉 **The** stars shine at night.
- 👉 **The** dog is barking loudly.

 **The** car is parked near the school.

 **The** river flows through the city.

More Uses of "The"

1. Talking About Something Specific

Use "the" when you are talking about something that everyone knows or something that has already been mentioned.

 "I saw the teacher in the classroom."
(This means a specific teacher that we both know.)

2. Unique Things

Use "the" before something that is the only one of its kind.

 "The Sun is bright today."
(There is only one sun, so we use "the".)

For example:

 **The rainbow** has many colours.

 **The sky** is blue during the day.

 **The Moon** comes out at night.

 **The world** is full of animals and plants.

 **The Sun** helps plants grow.

 **The stars** twinkle in the night sky.

 **The ocean** is home to many fish.

 **The Earth** revolves around the sun.

 **The internet** connects people around the world.

3. Mentioning Something Again

When you mention something for the second time, use "the".

👉 I saw a bird. The bird was flying high. (The first time we say "a bird" because it's not specific, but the second time we know which bird, so we use "the.")

For example:

👉 My friend gave me **a pencil**. **The pencil** is blue.

👉 I saw **a cat** in the garden. **The cat** was playing with a ball.

👉 She has **a toy car**. **The toy car** is red and shinny.

👉 There is **a big tree** in the park. **The tree** has many birds in it.

👉 We found **a book** in the classroom. **The book** was about animals.

Exercises

3.1

Write the correct article (a / an) before each noun:



_____ flower



_____ apple



_____ puppy



_____ log



_____ umbrella



_____ oven



_____ baseball



_____ idea

3.2

Underline the correct article (a / an / the) in each sentence:



I love to read a/an/the book.



Mary ate a/an/the egg for breakfast.



The truck was driving down a/an/the dirty road.



There is a chair a/an/the table.



A/an/the elephant has a/an/the long trunk.



a/an/the Earth spins around a/an/the sun.



That cat is stuck in a/an/the tree.



He carried a/an/the axe.



There is a/an/the inky spot on my pants.



A/an/the Sun helps plants grow.



Sami runs as fast as a/an/the cheetah.



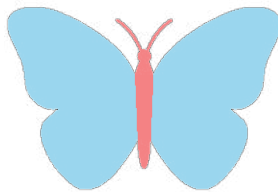
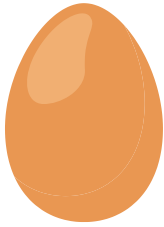
A/an/the cat jumped over a chair.



A/an/the apple fell from the tree.

3.3

Look at the pictures below. Decide if each one starts with "a" or "an." Then, write the name of picture to the correct box below.



an

a